History: The Black Death

Skill: So What? (developed explanation) | Warm-up 5, drill 10, paper 25 min

Writing target

- Evidence says what happened. So What says what it reveals. Write full, developed sentences: this is the biggest jump between levels.
- Link words: this suggests that / this reveals a society in which / underlying this was / which meant that / as a result / this was rare, which suggests

Remember the one habit

- Evidence tells us **what** happened. So What tells us what it **reveals**: what people believed, feared, wanted or depended on.
- Test: can you point back at your Evidence and show how your So What follows from it? If not, it is guessing.
- **Model (Rome):** *Slaves were legally property, which suggests that Roman society did not expect fairness for those at the bottom, because their labour was treated as something the powerful could own.*

Part 1: Evidence and claim check (7 min)

Write three facts about the Black Death from your class notes or memory. Use a name, date, number or place in each. Check each against your notes and circle one: supported / check / source needed.

My fact (with a date, number, name or place)	Claim check (circle one)
1.	supported / check / source needed
2.	supported / check / source needed
3.	supported / check / source needed

Part 2: So What drill (5 min)

Write only the So What sentence for each fact. Start with a link word from the box.

Part 3: Two paragraphs of a 12-mark answer (15 min)

Question: Explain why the Black Death had such a big impact on the lives of people in the Middle Ages. (12 marks)

Write only **two reasons** today. Each one: Point, Evidence, So What, in full sentences. Use only facts you marked supported.

Reason 1

Reason 2

Part 4: Self-check (3 min)

[ ] Every Evidence sentence is followed by a So What [ ] I can point back to the Evidence for each So What

[ ] No fact marked check or source needed is in my writing [ ] No modern word a person in the Middle Ages would not have used

Mark your writing: circle the level you reached.

Level	What it looks like
Level 1	General statements, little specific evidence.
Level 2	Some explanation but evidence is generic.
Level 3	Developed explanation with specific evidence for each reason.
Level 4	As Level 3, plus reasons linked and ranked (not yet the target).

Oral check (parent): pick one Evidence sentence and ask “So what does that tell us?” She answers without reading.